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MOTOR LOCKING MECHANISM INCLUDING MEMORY ALLOY WIRE

Abstract

A stabilization system includes a payload and one or more locking systems. Each of the one or more locking systems includes a motor including a stator and a rotor configured to rotate relative to the stator, a sliding structure capable of engaging the rotor to lock the rotor, and at least one memory alloy wire configured to engage the sliding structure to exert a first force to move the sliding structure in a first sliding direction from a first position to a second position when electrical energy is applied to the at least one memory alloy wire. When the sliding structure is at the first position, the rotor is not able to rotate relative to the stator by the sliding structure. When the sliding structure is at the second position, the rotor is able to rotate relative to the stator.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] The present application is a continuation of application Ser. No. 18/215,173, filed on Jun. 28, 2023, which is a continuation of International Application No. PCT/CN2020/141551, filed Dec. 30, 2020, the entire contents of both of which are incorporated herein by reference.

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TECHNICAL FIELD

[0003] The present disclosure relates generally to a locking mechanism including memory alloy wire, and more particularly, to motor locking apparatus and systems including memory alloy wire.

BACKGROUND

[0004] Size can be an important aspect of a mechanical apparatus, a motor, a medical device, or other apparatus, devices, and systems. The smaller the apparatus, the more convenience the user will experience, the less external limitation may be involved, and the more functions the apparatus may perform. However, small apparatus may present challenges as well. While less space and energy storage are needed, the complexity of tasks and delicacy of apparatus components may be increased.

[0005] Locking mechanisms have traditionally been controlled manually. However, as apparatus or components of apparatus become smaller than a convenient size, handling a locking mechanism with human hands or fingers can be difficult. Electrically controlled locking mechanism is a better choice. Moreover, electrically controlled locking mechanism may reduce the amount and complexity of orders for users to make. Locking and unlocking commands may even be automatically given and assured upon other conditions and information.

[0006] Shaking, displacement, and other unintended or inadvertent input present another challenge for small apparatus and the many delicate components of the small apparatus.

[0007] Therefore, there exists a need for improved locking mechanisms.

SUMMARY

[0008] Consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure, a locking apparatus comprises a sliding member or structure, and a first memory alloy wire configured to engage the sliding member to exert a first force to move the sliding member in a first sliding direction to a locked position when electrical energy is applied to the first memory alloy wire, where the applied electrical energy causes the first memory alloy wire to change length, the change in length exerting the first force to cause movement of the sliding member through the engagement of the first memory alloy wire with the sliding member. The locking apparatus further comprises a second memory alloy wire configured to engage the sliding member to exert a first force to move the sliding member in a second sliding direction to an unlocked position when electrical energy is applied to the second memory alloy wire, where the applied electrical energy causes the second memory alloy wire to change length, the change in length exerting the second force to cause movement of the sliding member through the engagement of the second memory alloy wire with

the sliding member. The apparatus further comprises a position limiting structure. When the sliding member is moved to the locked position, the position limiting structure holds the sliding member at the locked position. When the sliding member is moved to the unlocked position, the position limiting structure holds the sliding member at the unlocked position.

[0009] Consistent with some other embodiments of the present disclosure, a motor locking system for locking and unlocking a motor comprises a motor, a sliding member, and a first memory alloy wire configured to engage the sliding member to exert a first force to move the sliding member in a first sliding direction to a locked position when electrical energy is applied to the first memory alloy wire, where the applied electrical energy causes the first memory alloy wire to change length, the change in length exerting the first force to cause movement of the sliding member through the engagement of the first memory alloy wire with the sliding member. The motor locking system further comprises a second memory alloy wire configured to engage the sliding member to exert a second force to move the sliding member in a second sliding direction to an unlocked position when electrical energy is applied to the second memory alloy wire, where the applied electrical energy causes the second memory alloy wire to change length, the change in length exerting the second force to cause movement of the sliding member through the engagement of the second memory alloy wire with the sliding member.

[0010] It is to be understood that both the foregoing general description and the following detailed description are exemplary and explanatory only and are not restrictive of the invention, as claimed.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0011] FIG. 1 shows a side view of a first exemplary locking system in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0012] FIG. 2 shows a top view of a portion of the first exemplary locking system in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0013] FIG. 3 shows another view of the first exemplary locking system in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0014] FIG. 4 shows an exemplary application of the first exemplary locking system in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0015] FIG. 5 shows another side view of the first exemplary locking system in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0016] FIG. 6 shows another top view of the first exemplary locking system in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0017] FIG. 7 shows an exemplary plunger in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0018] FIG. 8 shows a top view of a second exemplary locking system in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0019] FIG. 9 shows a top view of a third exemplary locking system in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0020] FIG. 10 shows a top view of a fourth exemplary locking system in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0021] FIG. 11 shows an exemplary application of the fifth exemplary locking system in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0022] The following detailed description refers to the accompanying drawings. Wherever possible, the same reference numbers refer to the same or similar parts. While several illustrative embodiments are described herein, modifications, adaptations and other implementations are

possible. For example, substitutions, additions or modifications may be made to the components illustrated in the drawings. Accordingly, the following detailed description is not limited to the disclosed embodiments and examples. Instead, the proper scope is defined by the appended claims. [0023] Consistent with embodiments of the present disclosure, there are provided locking apparatus and systems including memory alloy wire.

[0024] FIG. 1 shows a side view of a first exemplary locking system **100** configured for locking and unlocking a motor **102**, in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure. Motor **102** may be a linear motor or a rotary motor. In FIG. 1, a body **110** is provided as a diagrammatical representation of the relationship of motor **102** with its parent apparatus, e.g., a vehicle or corresponding operating environment with which motor **102** is associated. For example, motor **102** may be a motor of a rotary joint associated with a gimbal and body **110** may be a portion of the gimbal. As another example, motor **102** may be a rotor of a rotor-propeller assembly associated with an aerial vehicle and body **110** may be an arm of the aerial vehicle on which the rotor is mounted. As a further example, motor **102** may be a linear vibrator of a cellphone and body **110** may be a portion of a shell of the cellphone. Motor **102** may rotate or translate relative to body **110** and the locking system is configured to prevent motor **102** from such rotational or translational movement.

[0025] A base **112** may serve as a platform on which various parts related to the locking mechanism of locking system **100** may be disposed and fixed. In some embodiments, base **112** may be disposed on body **110** and may be detachably fixed to body **110**. In some other embodiments, base **112** may be a part of body **110** and may not be detachable from body **110**. In FIG. 1, base **112** is provided as a diagrammatical representation of its relationship with the locking mechanism in the locking system **100**. The structure of base **112** may depend on various factors such as convenience and quality control of fabrication, costs, size, and mechanical and spatial requirements based on the particular application of the locking mechanism. For example, base **112** may have a simple shape and be a part of body **110**. As another example, base **112** may have an irregular shape and comprise multiple subcomponents. In exemplary locking system **100**, base **112** has a round disk shape with a slight radial expansion on one side for placing a sliding member **120**, as shown with more detail in a top view of locking system **100** in FIG. 2. Base **112** has a predetermined depth, as shown in the side view of locking system **100** in FIG. 1.

[0026] A sliding member **120** is configured to be movable along a surface of base **112**, e.g., in a track along a surface of base **112**. At one or more positions along a range of movement of sliding member **120**, motor **102** may be locked against movement, e.g., against rotation. At one or more positions along the range of movement of sliding member **120**, motor **102** may be unlocked. In some embodiments, the one or more positions may be one or more ranges rather than only one or more discrete positions. In the exemplary embodiments, sliding member **120** is configured to move between a locked position and an unlocked position.

[0027] Sliding member **120** is movable by one or more components of locking system **100**. Locking system **100** comprises one or more restoring members to exert forces to move sliding member **120**. For example, locking system **100** comprises a first restoring member **170** configured to exert a first force to move sliding member **120**. Locking system **100** further comprises a second restoring member **180** configured to exert a second force to move sliding member **120**. Restoring member **170** is configured to exert the first force to move sliding member **120** to a first position, e.g., the locked position. Restoring member **180** is configured to exert the second force to move sliding member **120** to a second position, e.g., the unlocked position.

[0028] Restoring member **170** includes a memory alloy wire, an elastic member such as a spring, or any suitable device, or a combination thereof. In the exemplary embodiments, restoring member **170** includes a first memory alloy wire **130**. Restoring member **180** includes a memory alloy wire, an elastic member such as a spring, or any suitable device, or a combination thereof. In the exemplary embodiments, restoring member **180** includes a second memory alloy wire **140**.

[0029] In FIG. 1, first memory alloy wire **130** and second memory alloy wire **140** are configured to move sliding member **120**. First memory alloy wire **130** and second memory alloy wire **140** each exert the first force and the second force respectively to move sliding member **120** through contact with a portion of sliding member **120**. First memory alloy wire **130** and second memory alloy wire **140** may each contact with sliding member **120** through one or more hooks, protrusions, buckles, channels, or any other configuration to enable the driving of sliding member **120**. First memory alloy wire **130** and second memory alloy wire **140** may be in contact with sliding member **120** all the time, or may only be in contact when driving sliding member **120**.

[0030] In some embodiments, sliding member **120** includes a first coupling portion configured to engage first memory alloy wire **130** to move sliding member **120**, and a second coupling portion configured to engage second memory alloy wire **130** to move sliding member **120**. In the exemplary embodiments, the first coupling portion includes a protrusion **113** configured so that first memory alloy wire **130** can be detachably wrapped around a portion of first protrusion **113** to be capable of pulling sliding member **120** by exerting the first force on first protrusion **113**. Similarly, the second coupling portion includes a protrusion **114** configured so that second memory alloy wire **140** can be detachably wrapped around a portion of second protrusion **114** to be capable of pulling sliding member **120** through second protrusion **114**. In some other embodiments, at least one of first memory alloy wire **130** and second memory alloy wire **140** may wrap around more than one protrusion on sliding member **120** and move sliding member **120** by exerting the second force on the more than one protrusion. In yet some other embodiments, first protrusion **113** may engage an end of first memory alloy wire **130** and enable first memory alloy wire **130** to move sliding member **120** by pulling in the same direction of a straight line wire contraction and its actuated displacement. The use and allocation of first memory alloy wire **130** and second memory alloy wire **140** with respect to the locking mechanism and other components of locking system **100** are described in greater detail with reference to FIG. 2.

[0031] The first coupling portion and the second coupling portion may include any suitable structure (e.g., protrusions, channels, grooves, etc.) to engage restoring member **170** and restoring member **180**. For example, the first coupling portion may include a first channel through sliding member **120** to engage first memory alloy wire **130** and the second coupling portion may include a second channel through sliding member **120** to engage second memory alloy wire **140**. As another example, when restoring member **180** is an elastic member such as a spring, the second coupling portion may include second protrusion **114**, or any structure suitable to connect with the spring restoring member. Similarly, when restoring member **170** is a spring, the first coupling portion may include first protrusion **113**, or any structure suitable to connect with the spring restoring member.

[0032] In some embodiments, locking system **100** may comprise a path limiting structure or apparatus to limit the movement of sliding member **120**. In some exemplary embodiments, the path limiting structure may be a cap **160**. Cap **160** may limit the movement of the sliding member between the locked position and the unlocked position along a given movement path. Cap **160** is described in greater detail with reference to FIG. 3.

[0033] In the exemplary embodiments, sliding member **120** is configured to move between a locked position and an unlocked position, in which motor **102** is locked against movement and unlocked, respectively. Locking system **100** may comprise a position limiting structure **105**, to maintain discrete positions of sliding member **120**, to resolve a number of engineering issues. For example, without a position limiting structure, after first memory alloy wire **130** has moved slider block **120** to the locked position, first memory alloy wire **130** may need a continuous electrical energy supply to ensure slider block **120** remains at the locked position, assuming no other position limiting mechanism. This may cause an undesirable increase in the electrical energy usage and adversely affect the life of related components. In addition, first memory alloy wire **130** itself may not be able to maintain slider block **120** accurately and stably at the locked position, especially when a sudden external force is applied. Second memory alloy wire **140** with respect to the

unlocked position may have similar concerns.

[0034] Position limiting structure **105** may include one or more positioning portions each configured to selectively engage one or more engaging portions of sliding member **120** when sliding member **120** is at different positions. The one or more positioning portions may each comprise a leaf spring, a lever, a plunger ball, a protrusion, or any other suitable structure or mechanism. The engaging portions of sliding member **120** may each comprise a groove, a protrusion, or any other suitable structure or mechanism for the at least one positioning to engage. In some exemplary embodiments as shown in FIG. **1**, position limiting structure **105** includes a positioning portion that comprises a leaf spring **150**. Leaf spring **150** is configured to engage a first one of the engaging portions of sliding member **120** when sliding member **120** is at the locked position. Leaf spring **150** is configured to engage a second one of the engaging portions of sliding member **120** when sliding member **120** is at the unlocked position. In the exemplary embodiments shown in FIG. **1**, the first engaging portion is a groove **123** at the bottom of sliding member **120** and the second engaging portion is a groove **124** also at the bottom of sliding member **120**. Groove **123** is on the right and groove **124** is on the left, as viewed in FIG. **1**. A fitting portion of leaf spring **150** has any suitable shape to engage with either of groove **123** or groove **124**. In the exemplary embodiments, the shape of the fitting portion of leaf spring **150** has a protrusion shape similar to the top side contour of a speed bump. In some other embodiments, the fitting portion of leaf spring **150** may have a different protrusion shape, or other type of shape or structure suitable.

[0035] In some other embodiments, sliding member **120** includes at least one or more engaging portions each configured to be selectively engaged by one or more positioning portions of position limiting structure **105** when sliding member **120** is at different positions. For example, sliding member **120** may include an engaging portion and position limiting structure **105** may include a first positioning portion and a second positioning portion. The first positioning portion is configured to engage the engaging portion when sliding member **120** is at the locked position, thereby immobilizing sliding member **120** at the locked position. The second positioning portion is configured to engage the engaging portion when sliding member **120** is at the unlocked position, thereby immobilizing sliding member **120** at the unlocked position.

[0036] Groove **123** and groove **124** may have the same shape or different shapes with each other. The shape(s) of groove **123** and groove **124** may be any suitable shape or structure that can fit or receive the corresponding fitting portion of leaf spring **150** and provide enough resistance such that sliding member **120** may not easily move from a current position while still allowing block **120** to be moved out of the current position when sufficient force is applied. In some exemplary embodiments, groove **123** and groove **124** may both have a concave shape closely mirroring the protrusion shape of the corresponding fitting portion of leaf spring **150** so that groove **123** or groove **124** may effectively engage leaf spring **150** to prevent unintended movement of sliding member from the locked or unlocked position. When sliding member **120** is moved to the locked position, the fitting portion of leaf spring **150** of protrusion shape may be received in groove **123**, thereby immobilizing sliding member at the locked position. Similarly, when sliding member **120** is moved to the unlocked position, the fitting portion of leaf spring **150** of protrusion shape may be received in groove **124**, thereby immobilizing sliding member **120** at the unlocked position.

[0037] In some other embodiments, position limiting structure **105** may include a plunger. The plunger may be a spring plunger. The plunger and the use and allocation of the plunger by position limiting structure **105** and locking system **100** are described in greater detail with reference to FIGS. **7** and **8**.

[0038] In some embodiments, an electrically controlled locking apparatus may comprise one or more components of locking system **100** and may be for use of locking an object other than a motor. For example, when motor **102** is replaced by a door or a portion of a door, locking system **100** may form a door locking apparatus. As another example, locking system **100** and sliding member **120** may be configured to control operation of an electrically controlled valve.

[0039] FIG. 2 shows a top view of a portion of locking system **100** in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure. In order to better show certain components and structure of locking system **100** such as the shape of first memory alloy wire **130** and second memory alloy wire **140**, cap **160** of locking system **100** is not shown in FIG. 2.

[0040] First memory alloy wire **130** and second memory alloy wire **140** are made of Nickel titanium (Nitinol), Nitinol alloys, or other suitable materials, or combinations or alloys thereof. Memory alloy wires facilitate operation of the locking mechanism disclosed herein and locking system **100** by means of their temperature-dependent characteristics of transformation, and more specifically, electrically controllable change in wire shape and length. Such characteristics enable electrically controlled displacement and actuation of sliding member **120** based on the control of electrical energy supply to first memory alloy wire **120** or second memory alloy wire **130**. In the exemplary embodiments, first memory alloy wire **130** and second memory alloy wire **140** shorten (contract) when provided with electrical energy. For example, if first memory alloy wire **130** wraps around a portion of first protrusion of sliding member **120** to be capable of pulling sliding member **120** by exerting the first force on first protrusion **113**, first memory alloy wire **130** forms an acute angle θ with the displacement direction and the displacement actuated by first memory alloy wire may be the memory alloy wire contraction multiplied by one or more factors including a cosine θ . As another example, if first memory alloy wire **130** or second memory alloy wire **140** is in a straight line shape and has one end fixed and the other end movable for actuation, the displacement actuated by memory alloy wire contraction when provided with electrical energy would equal to the contraction in length of the straight line memory alloy wire.

[0041] Conventionally, memory alloy wires are used in straight line or coil shape. However, straight line shape may not be an efficient use of space in a small apparatus context. Coil shape has other drawbacks such as insufficient driving force. Even if thicker wires may be applied to increase the driving force for coil shape memory alloy wires, this may cause new problem such as a decrease in responsiveness.

[0042] Various means optimizing the displacement by memory alloy wires may be applied to locking system **100**. Memory alloy wires can form W-shapes, V-shapes, pentagonal arrow shapes, or other suitable shapes to achieve an efficient use of space. This is particularly beneficial for objects and devices that have limited space. For example, as shown in FIG. 2, second memory alloy wire **140** may form an approximate W-shape. Second memory alloy wire **140** has two fixed ends where the ends are fixed to a terminal **241** and a terminal **242**. Two fixed ends **241** and **242** terminals are each at an end of the W-shape at the side. Second memory alloy wire **140** has one or more turning points between the two fixed ends to form the W-shape. The one or more turning points include turning points **243** and **244** as two bottom ends of the W-shape and a middle top turning point where second memory alloy wire **140** further engages second protrusion **114** to form the W-shape. Only a middle point of the W-shape at protrusion **114** is movable so that the displacement caused when second memory alloy wire **140** contracts may be transferred to the movable middle point, thereby amplifying displacement with respect to the limited space around movable middle point and the corresponding movement of second protrusion **114**. Base **112** may include suitable structures, e.g., protrusions such as pins, for second memory alloy wire **140** to engage at turning points **243** and **244**. In some embodiments, base **112** may have additional structure to hold second memory alloy wire **140** to maintain the W-shape stable. For example, base **112** may have a protrusion at turning point **243** and a protrusion at turning point **244**, each having a channel configured to guide second memory alloy wire **140** and to allow it to engage, while not fixing any portion of second memory alloy wire **140** at the turning points **243** or **244**, so that any contraction of second memory alloy wire **140** may be freely transferred through the turning points and contribute to the displacement at the movable middle point.

[0043] As shown in FIG. 2, first memory alloy wire **130** may form part of an approximate pentagonal arrow shape. First memory alloy wire **130** has two fixed ends at terminals **231** and **232**

each at an end of the pentagonal arrow, and one or more turning points between the two ends of the pentagonal arrow. The one or more turning points of first memory alloy wire **130** include two turning points **233** and **234** at pentagonal arrow side vertices, and a movable middle point at first protrusion **113** at the pentagonal arrow tip. This configuration amplifies displacement at the movable middle point as contraction on first memory alloy wire **130** is transferred to the movable middle point, within the limited space around the movable middle point and the corresponding movement of first protrusion **113**. As shown in FIG. 2, base **112** may include suitable structures, e.g., protrusions such as pins, for first memory alloy wire **130** to engage at turning points **233** and **234**. In some embodiments, base **112** may have additional structure to hold first memory alloy wire **130** to maintain the pentagonal arrow shape stable. For example, base **112** may have protrusions at turning points **233** and **234** each having a channel configured to guide first memory alloy wire **130** and to allow it to engage, while not fixing any portion of first memory alloy wire **130** at the turning points **233** or **234**, so that any contraction of first memory alloy wire **130** may be freely transferred through the turning points and contribute to the displacement at the movable middle point.

[0044] In some embodiments, first memory alloy wire **130** and second memory alloy wire **140** have their ends fixed to base **112** or structures on base **112**. In some other embodiments, first memory alloy wire **130** and second memory alloy wire **140** may extend beyond or beneath base **112**, such as through holes in base **112**, before being fixed at the respective end(s). This may provide additional length for the memory alloy wires and therefore additional potential displacements, but may be at the cost of increased complexity in fabrication.

[0045] In some embodiments, first memory alloy wire **130** and second memory alloy wire **140** may have their ends each fixed to a connecting structure on base **112**, illustrated as terminals **231**, **232**, **241**, and **242**. Fixing to the connecting structure may be in any suitable manner, for example via welding, snap-fit, friction-fit, buckle, bayonet, latch, lock, or otherwise connection, or a combination thereof.

[0046] In some embodiments, the connecting structure on base **112** may comprise connection with an electrical energy supply for first memory alloy wire **130** and second memory alloy wire **140**. For example, one or more circuits may be connected to some or all of the connecting structures on base **112** at or around the wire ends at terminals **231**, **232**, **241**, and **242**, to enable provision of electrical energy to first memory alloy wire **130** and second memory alloy wire **140**.

[0047] As shown in FIG. 2, motor **102** may have at least one structure for sliding member **120** to engage locking motor **102**. Such structure of motor **102** and the corresponding interface portion of sliding member **120** may be grooves, protrusions, or openings, or any otherwise suitable structures on an outer surface of motor **102** and sliding member **120**. In the exemplary embodiments, motor **102** may have one motor groove **202** for sliding member **120** to engage to lock motor **102**. In some other embodiments, motor **102** may have more than one such structure for sliding member **120** to engage.

[0048] When sliding member **102** is in the locked position, a portion of sliding member **120** engages, i.e., fits into motor groove **202**, thereby preventing motor **102** from rotating. When sliding member **102** is in the unlocked position, sliding member **120** is disengaged from motor groove **202**.

[0049] In some embodiments, sliding member **120** fits into motor groove **202** via a sloped surface. The sloped surface may protect sliding member **120** from being broken by allowing sliding member **120** to move away from motor groove **202** when a sudden force is applied causing displacement between sliding member **120** and motor **102**. Protective designs such as the sloped design for motor groove **202** in the exemplary embodiments are not essential to the functioning of the locking mechanism, but rather just to provide an engineering aspect to protect components of locking system **100** under rare and/or adverse situations. Forces, including friction, among motor groove **202**, sliding member **120**, and position limiting structure **105** contribute to maintaining motor **102** in a locked state and may be configured differently and adjusted to be proportional to the need of locking. For example, locking system **100** may function as a brake for stopping rotors

actuating propellers, while the sloped design of motor groove **202**, or other protective design, may still be present to allow sliding member **120** to disengage when the motor rotor is moved to rotate at high speed or when certain components receive a sudden impact.

[0050] In some embodiments, sliding member **120** may fit closely with the corresponding structure on motor **102** for locking. For example, with reference to FIG. 2, motor groove **202** may closely receive the corresponding portion of sliding member **120** fitting into motor groove **202** so that motor **102** may not rotate through any angle when sliding block **120** is in the locked position. In some other embodiments, the structure on motor **102** may allow motor **102** to have limited translational and/or rotational displacement relative to sliding member **120** when sliding member **120** is in the locked position. For example, motor groove **202** may be wider than the corresponding portion of sliding member **120** so that motor **102** may rotate through a certain angle when sliding member **120** is in the locked position.

[0051] In some embodiments, first memory alloy wire **130** may contract when electrical energy is applied thereto, thereby pulling protrusion **113** in a first direction to the locked position. Second memory alloy wire **140** may contract when electrical energy is applied thereto, thereby pulling protrusion **114** in a second direction to the unlocked position. In some other embodiments, first memory alloy wire **130** or second memory alloy wire **140** may push or otherwise actuate sliding member **120** to the locked or unlocked position. In some further embodiments, electrical energy may be applied to first memory alloy wire **130** until sliding member **120** is moved to the locked position, and electrical energy may be applied to second memory alloy wire **140** until sliding member **120** is moved to the unlocked position.

[0052] In some other embodiments, a spring structure pushing or pulling sliding member **120** away from the locked position may be present such that electrical energy may need to be continuously applied to first memory alloy wire **130** to maintain sliding member **120** in the locked position against a force of the spring's structure. Similarly, electrical energy may need to be continuously applied to second memory alloy wire **140**.

[0053] In some embodiments, motor **102** includes a motor rotor at the center or a central axis of motor **102** and a motor stator located at an outer periphery in the top view of locking system **100** (FIG. 2). The motor rotor is configured to rotate relative to the motor stator when motor **102** is operating. In some embodiments, the first direction may be radially inward towards motor **102** at the central axis of motor **102**, and the second direction may be radially outward away from the central axis of motor **102**. The first direction may be opposite to the second direction. In some other embodiments, motor **102** may have one or more peripheral parts in a top view of locking system **100** that rotates with the motor rotor at the center axis motor **102**, such as a shell **250**. The structure on motor **102** for engaging slider block **120** in the locked position may be on shell **250**. Slider block **120** may thus move radially outward to a locked position.

[0054] In some other embodiments, motor **102** may not be at the center. For example, motor **102** may be at an outer periphery in a top view of locking system **100** while the motor stator is at the center. The first direction to the locked position may thus be radially outward to motor **102** at the outer, while the second direction to the unlocked position may be radially inward. In some other embodiments, the first direction to the locked position may yet be radially inward to the motor stator.

[0055] In yet some other embodiments, the first direction and/or the second direction of movement of slider block **120** may not be along radial direction(s). For example, the first direction may have a tangential or axial directional component. In some other embodiments, the displacement at the movable middle point of first memory alloy wire **130** or second memory alloy wire **140** may not be along radial direction(s). For example, a transmission mechanism may be present in locking system **100** so that when the movable middle point of first memory alloy wire **130** moves with a tangential or axial directional component, the transmission mechanism change the direction of output driving force from the movable middle point to be radial and actuates sliding member **120** to move radially

to reach a locked position.

[0056] In some embodiments, a sensing device may monitor whether locking or unlocking of motor **120** is achieved. The sensing device may be any suitable sensor that can measure whether one or more components of locking system **100** is at a state corresponding to the locked or unlocked position, such as if motor **102** is locked/unlocked or if sliding member **120** is at the locked/unlocked position. For example, the sensing device may be a photoelectric sensor measuring if sliding member **120** is at the locked/unlocked position. As another example, because the resistance of a memory alloy wire changes with the length, the sensing device may be a resistance sensor measuring resistance of first memory alloy wire **130** and/or second memory alloy wire **140** and thereby determining the corresponding displacement of first protrusion **113** and/or second protrusion **114**.

[0057] FIG. **3** shows another view of locking system **100** in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure. As shown in FIG. **3**, cap **160** may include a first channel **313** limiting the movement of first protrusion **113**, thereby limiting sliding member **120** movement along channel **313**. As also shown in FIG. **3**, cap **160** may include a second channel **314** limiting the movement of second protrusion **114**, thereby limiting sliding member **120** movement along second channel **314**. In some embodiments, first channel **313** and second channel **314** may be straight channel. In some further embodiments, first channel **313** and second channel **314** may be along the radial direction so that sliding member **120** may move either towards motor **102** or away from motor **102**. First channel **313** may have one end open, given that sliding member **120** is limited position limiting factors such as second channel **314**, motor **102**, and position limiting structure **105**.

[0058] In some other embodiments, channel(s) on cap **160** may not be straight or at radial direction. For example, channel(s) on cap **160** may be of sufficient width to allow tangential movement of protrusions of sliding member **120** at a certain radial location in order to render different actuations of memory alloy wires and sliding member **120** feasible. In yet some other embodiments, path limiting structure limiting movement of sliding member **120** may be of a different structure and may be at a different location relative to sliding member **120**.

[0059] Cap **160** may be disposed on or above sliding member **120**. Cap **160** may have one end attached to base **112** or body **110** so that users and engineers may open cap **160** to conduct specific operations on components beneath. Cap **160** may be attached to base **112** or body **110** in any suitable manner, for example by welding, or by a snap-fit, friction-fit, screw-fit, buckle, bayonet, latch, lock, or otherwise secure connection. Apart from the path limiting functions as described above, cap **160** may shield components of locking system **100**, such as sliding member **120** and some portions of first memory alloy wire **130** and second memory alloy wire **140**, from contamination, damage, and inadvertent touch.

[0060] FIG. **4** shows an exemplary application of locking system **100** in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure. The exemplary application of locking system **100** may be a stabilization system **400** or a device comprising stabilization system **400**. Stabilization system **400** may include one or more devices configured to hold a payload **440** and/or allow payload **440** to be adjusted with respect to up to six degrees of freedom (e.g., three translational directions along its coordinate axes and three rotational directions about its coordinate axes). For example, stabilization system **400** may be a gimbal configured to adjust the attitude of payload **440**. Payload **440** may be cargo, optical equipment (e.g., photo cameras, video cameras, etc.), sensory equipment, or other types of payload. Stabilization system **400** may be configured to allow payload **440** to be rotated about one or more of the axes. In some embodiments, stabilization system **400** may be configured to allow 360° of rotation about each axis to allow for greater control of the prospective of payload **440**. In other embodiments, stabilization system **400** may limit the range of rotation of payload **440** to less than 360° (e.g., ≤270°, ≤210°, ≤120°, ≤90°, ≤45°, ≤15°, etc.), about one or more of its axes.

[0061] Locking system **100** may be applied to at least one of the one or more axes of stabilization system **400**. In the exemplary application of locking system **100** shown in FIG. **4**, locking system

100 may be applied to one or more of rotary joints of stabilization system **400**. In some embodiments, stabilization system **400** comprises a yaw axis locking system **410**, a roll axis locking system **420**, and a pitch axis locking system **430**. Yaw axis locking system **410** includes a motor **412** configured to rotate about a yaw axis of stabilization system **400**. In some embodiments, yaw axis locking system **410** is configured to lock a rotation of motor **412** in the same way as locking system **100** described above. Roll axis locking system **420** includes a motor **422** configured to rotate about a roll axis of stabilization system **400**. In some embodiments, roll axis locking system **420** is configured to lock a rotation of motor **422** in the same way as locking system **100** described above. Pitch axis locking system **430** includes a motor **432** configured to rotate about a pitch axis of stabilization system **400**. In some embodiments, pitch axis locking system **430** is configured to lock a rotation of motor **432** in the same way as locking system **100** described above. [0062] In some other embodiments, some or all of yaw axis locking system **410**, roll axis locking system **420**, and pitch axis locking system **430** apply a locking system that is similar to locking system **100** but with certain different configurations, such as the exemplary embodiments of locking systems described in detail below with reference to FIGS. 8-10.

[0063] In some embodiments, stabilization system **400** may automatically lock some or all of its motors when its motors are powered off. For example, in such embodiments, stabilization system **400** is configured to move a sliding member in yaw axis locking system **410** to a locked position (or keep the sliding member at the locked position) when motor **412** is powered off. This may be achieved by a system control without need of additional user input so that a user of stabilization system **400** does not need to provide an additional user command after turning off the motors of stabilization system **400**. This is also helpful in emergency situations in which a user command may not be timely for locking the rotation of rotary joints.

[0064] In some embodiments, stabilization system **400** may automatically lock some or all of its motors when its motors are in standby mode. For example, in such embodiments, stabilization system **400** is configured to exert a force to move a sliding member in roll axis locking system **420** to a locked position (or keep the sliding member at the locked position) when motor **422** is in standby mode in which motor **422** is connected to electrical energy and ready to rotate, but does not rotate until receiving a command to rotate. This may be achieved by a system control without need of user input so that a user of stabilization system **400** does not need to remember to provide a user command to secure one or more rotary joints from inadvertent rotating when the motors of stabilization system **400** are in standby mode.

[0065] With locking system **100** applied, users do not need to manually find and push any button to mechanically lock the rotary joints. Rather, users may simply click on a remote control to enable locking system **100** to switch between locked and unlocked positions, electrically achieved by actuating sliding member **120** to the locked and unlocked positions. In some embodiments, the switching between locked and unlocked positions may be automatically achieved when stabilization system **400** is conducting other user commands or fulfilling various missions under certain operating modes. For example, when a user turns off stabilization system **400**, all rotary joints applying locking system **100** may switch to locked position after a certain predetermined period of time, thereby allowing the user to adjust the arm configuration within the predetermined period of time and preventing rotary motions of the arms that might hit objects in the environment afterwards. As another example, locking system **100** may be applied as a brake for movable devices actuated by one or more rotor-blade assemblies, such as a helicopter or a Multi-rotor unmanned aerial vehicle **500** shown in FIG. 11. Locking system **100** may be applied to lock the one or more rotor-blade assemblies of the movable device, thereby immediately reducing the rotating speed of one or more rotors of the rotor-blade assemblies to zero. This may prevent the rotating rotor-blade assemblies from damaging other objects, such as a parachute released from the movable device in an emergency setting. In some embodiments, locking system **100** may function as a means to reduce the degrees of freedom of stabilization system **400**. For example, a user may choose to lock

a particular joint between two arms to prevent the two arms from any relative movement (e.g., rotational and/or translational movement). The two arms may then be considered as one rigid arm and thereby reduce one or more degrees of freedom.

[0066] In yet other embodiments, stabilization system **400** may be configured to allow 360° of rotation about an axis when the corresponding locking system is in the unlocked position, but may limit range of rotation of payload **440** to less than 360° when the corresponding locking system is in locked position. For example, as described above with reference to FIG. 2, motor groove **202** may be wider than the corresponding portion of sliding member **120** so that motor **102** may rotate through a certain angle when sliding member **120** is in the locked position.

[0067] In some embodiments, locking system **100** may be configured to lock a rotary motor at a specific angle. For example, this may be achieved by having groove **202** at a specific angular location of the rotor of motor **102** such that the motor **102** rotor may be at a specific angle when slider block **120** fits into groove **202** at the locked position.

[0068] FIG. 5 shows another side view of locking system **100** in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure. FIG. 5 is similar to FIG. 1, wherein symbols which are the same as those used in FIG. 1 indicate the same parts of locking system **100**. FIG. 5 shows a state of locking system **100** in which sliding member **120** is at the unlocked position and motor **102** is unlocked. This is different from the state of locking system **100** shown in FIG. 1 in that sliding member **120** is at the locked position and motor **102** is locked against movement in FIG. 1.

[0069] FIG. 5 illustrates differences between the state of lock system **100** in which sliding member **120** is at the unlocked position and the state of lock system **100** in which sliding member **120** is at the locked position, as shown in FIG. 1. Therefore FIG. 5 does not illustrate every symbol or component already shown in FIG. 1 and not necessary to illustrate the differences.

[0070] FIG. 5 also differs from FIG. 1 in that the fitting portion (protrusion) of leaf spring **150** is received in groove **124**, thereby immobilizing sliding member at the unlocked position. In FIG. 1, the fitting portion (protrusion) of leaf spring **150** is received in groove **123**, thereby immobilizing sliding member at the locked position.

[0071] FIG. 6 shows another top view of locking system **100** in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure. FIG. 6 is similar to FIG. 2, wherein symbols which are the same as those used in FIG. 2 indicate the same parts of locking system **100**. FIG. 6 shows a state of locking system **100** in which sliding member **120** is at the unlocked position and motor **102** is unlocked. This is different from the state of locking system **100** shown in FIG. 2 in that sliding member **120** is at the locked position and motor **102** is locked against movement in FIG. 2.

[0072] FIG. 6 illustrates differences between the state of lock system **100** in which sliding member **120** is at the unlocked position and the state of lock system **100** in which sliding member **120** is at the locked position, as shown in FIG. 2. Therefore FIG. 6 does not illustrate every symbol or component already shown in FIG. 2 and not necessary to illustrate the differences.

[0073] FIG. 6 is also different from FIG. 2 in that sliding member **120** is positioned away from, i.e., not received by or engaging, groove **202** of motor **102**. As shown in FIG. 2, sliding member **120** engages groove **202** to lock motor **102**. Groove **202** receives the corresponding portion of sliding member **120** fitting into motor groove **202** so that motor **102** cannot rotate when sliding block **120** is in the locked position. In contrast as shown in FIG. 6, groove **202** does not receive any portion of sliding member **120** and motor **102** can rotate without any obstruction from sliding member **120**.

[0074] FIG. 7 shows an exemplary plunger **700** to be used in exemplary locking system **100** in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure. In some embodiments, plunger **700** includes a plunger shell **730**. Plunger **700** also includes an elastic portion **710** and a positioning portion **720**. Elastic portion **710** may comprise a coil spring, a leaf spring, a rubber column, or other suitable device, or a combination thereof. Elastic portion **710** is configured to move positioning portion **720** by an elastic force of the elastic portion. For example, as shown in FIG. 7, elastic portion **710** comprises a spring having a first end **711** in contact with positioning portion

720 and a second end **712** in contact with plunger shell **730**. Elastic portion **710** exerts the elastic force in direction **715** and is configured to move positioning portion **720** in direction **715**.

[0075] Positioning portion **720** is configured to engage a portion or a component of sliding member **120** and provide a position limiting function against sliding member **120**. Positioning portion **720** includes a first end **721** in contact with elastic portion **710** and a second end **722** configured to hold sliding member **120**. For example, position limiting structure **105** may include plunger **700** instead of spring leaf **150** as shown in FIG. 1 to hold sliding member **120** at the locked position when sliding member **120** is at the locked position. Positioning portion **720** may comprise a positioning protrusion at second end **722** to engage engaging portion **122** of sliding member **120** at groove **124** or groove **123**. Because elastic portion **710** exerts the elastic force in direction **715** regardless of the position of sliding member **120**, the elastic force moves positioning portion **720** into groove **123** or groove **124** when positioning portion **720** matches groove **123** or groove **124**. Therefore, when sliding member **120** is moved to the locked position, positioning portion **720** is moved by elastic portion **710** and the positioning protrusion is received in groove **123**, thereby immobilizing sliding member **120** at the locked position. Similarly, when sliding member **120** is moved to the unlocked position, positioning portion **720** is moved by elastic portion **710** and the positioning protrusion is received in groove **124**, thereby immobilizing sliding member **120** at the unlocked position.

[0076] In some embodiments, positioning portion **720** comprises a plunger ball and sliding member **120** includes an engaging groove corresponding to the plunger ball such that the plunger ball may engage the engaging groove to hold sliding member **120**. Shell **730** includes an opening **732** to allow at least a part of positioning portion **720** to be positioned outside shell **730**. In some embodiments, positioning portion **720** comprises a plunger ball and the width of opening **732** is smaller than the diameter of the plunger ball so that plunger ball is secured from dropping out of shell **730**.

[0077] FIG. 8 shows a top view of a second exemplary locking system **800** in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure. Locking system **800** is similar to locking system **100** and FIG. 8 is similar to FIG. 2, wherein symbols which are the same as those used in FIGS. 1 and 2 indicate the same parts of locking system **100**. As shown in FIG. 8, locking system **800** has a configuration different from the configuration of locking system **100** shown in FIG. 2 primarily regarding position limiting structure **105** and engaging portion(s) at sliding member **120**. In FIG. 8, position limiting structure **105** includes at least one positioning portion comprising plunger **700** capable of immobilizing sliding member **120** at the locked and unlocked positions, as compared to leaf spring **150** of the positioning portion in the embodiments shown in FIGS. 1 and 2. Locking system **800** is also different from locking system **100** in that first memory alloy wire **130** is radially positioned further from the central axis of motor **102** than second memory alloy wire **140** in FIG. 8.

[0078] FIG. 8 illustrates differences in configuration between locking system **800** and locking system **100**. FIG. 8 does not illustrate every symbol or component already shown in FIGS. 1 and 2 and not necessary to illustrate the differences.

[0079] As shown in FIG. 8, sliding member **120** includes a side **821** and a side **822**. In some embodiments, position limiting structure **105** includes a first positioning portion at side **821** and a second positioning portion at side **822**. Sliding member **120** includes a first engaging portion and a second engaging portion at side **821**. In some embodiments, position limiting structure **105** includes plunger **700**, as described with reference to FIG. 7, at side **821**. The first positioning portion comprises a first plunger ball of plunger **700** configured to engage the first engaging portion when sliding member **120** is moved to the locked position, thereby immobilizing sliding member **120** at the locked position. The first plunger ball is further configured to engage the second engaging portion when sliding member **120** is moved to the unlocked position, thereby immobilizing sliding member **120** at the unlocked position. Similarly, sliding member **120** includes a third engaging portion and a fourth engaging portion at side **822**. Position limiting structure **105** includes another plunger **700** at side **822** and the second positioning portion comprises a second

plunger ball of the another plunger **700** configured to engage the third engaging portion when sliding member **120** is moved to the locked position, thereby immobilizing sliding member **120** at the locked position. The second plunger ball is further configured to engage the fourth engaging portion when sliding member **120** is moved to the unlocked position, thereby immobilizing sliding member **120** at the unlocked position.

[0080] In other embodiments, position limiting structure **105** includes only one positioning portion such as the plunger ball of plunger **700** described above. The positioning portion and the corresponding engaging portions at the same side of sliding member **120** are configured in the same way as either of the first positioning portion or the second positioning portion described above.

[0081] FIG. **9** shows a top view of a third exemplary locking system **900** in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure. Locking system **900** is similar to locking system **100** and FIG. **9** is similar to FIG. **2**, wherein symbols which are the same as those used in FIGS. **1** and **2** indicate the same parts of locking system **100**. For example, restoring member **170** includes first memory alloy wire **130** configured to exert a first force to move sliding member **120** to the locked position, which is the same for both locking systems **100** and **900**.

[0082] As shown in FIG. **9**, locking system **900** has a configuration different from the configuration of locking system **100** shown in FIG. **2** regarding restoring member **180**. In particular, instead of including second memory alloy wire **140** in FIG. **2**, restoring member **180** in FIG. **9** includes a spring **940** configured to exert a second force to move sliding member **120** in the second direction to the unlocked position.

[0083] Sliding member **120** in locking system **900** is slightly different only due to the different embodiment of restoring member **180** as compared with locking system **100** shown in FIG. **2** in that, protrusion **114** wrapped by second memory alloy wire **140** is not present as in FIG. **2**. In the exemplary embodiment shown in FIG. **9**, sliding member **120** includes any suitable structure or portion configured to allow restoring member **180** to exert a second force to move sliding member **120**, such as a surface **914** in contact with an end of spring **940**.

[0084] In some embodiments, spring **940** exerts a pulling force on sliding member **120** in the second direction to the unlocked position when sliding member **120** is not in the unlocked position. The pulling force of spring **940** is large enough to overcome any position limiting structure of locking system **900** to move sliding member away from the locked position. Therefore, electrical energy may need to be continuously applied to first memory alloy wire **130** to maintain sliding member **120** in the locked position against the pulling force of spring **940**.

[0085] FIG. **9** illustrates differences in configuration between locking system **900** and locking system **100**. FIG. **9** does not illustrate every symbol or component already shown in FIGS. **1** and **2** and not necessary to illustrate the differences.

[0086] FIG. **10** shows a top view of a fourth exemplary locking system **1000** in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure. Locking system **1000** is similar to locking system **100** and FIG. **10** is similar to FIG. **2**, wherein symbols which are the same as those used in FIGS. **1** and **2** indicate the same parts of locking system **100**. For example, restoring member **180** includes second memory alloy wire **140** configured to exert a second force to move sliding member **120** to the unlocked position, which is the same for both locking systems **100** and **1000**.

[0087] As shown in FIG. **10**, locking system **1000** has a configuration different from the configuration of locking system **100** shown in FIG. **2** regarding restoring member **170**. In particular, instead of including first memory alloy wire **130** in FIG. **2**, restoring member **170** in FIG. **10** includes a spring **1030** configured to exert a first force to move sliding member **120** in the first direction to the locked position.

[0088] In some embodiments, spring **1030** exerts a pushing force on sliding member **120** in the first direction to the locked position when sliding member **120** is not in the locked position. The pushing force from spring **1030** is large enough to overcome any position limiting structure of locking

system **1000** to move sliding member away from the unlocked position. Therefore, electrical energy may need to be continuously applied to second memory alloy wire **140** to maintain sliding member **120** in the unlocked position against the pushing force from spring **1030**.

[0089] Sliding member **120** is slightly different in locking system **1000** only due to the different embodiment of restoring member **170** as compared with locking system **100** shown in FIG. 2 in that, protrusion **113** wrapped with first memory alloy wire **130** is not present in the same way as in FIG. 2. In the exemplary embodiment shown in FIG. 10, sliding member **120** includes any suitable structure or portion configured to allow restoring member **170** to exert the first force to move sliding member **120**, such as a surface **1014** in connection with an end of spring **1030**.

[0090] FIG. 10 illustrates differences in configuration between locking system **1000** and locking system **100**. FIG. 10 does not illustrate every symbol or component already shown in FIGS. 1 and 2 and not necessary to illustrate the key differences.

[0091] It is to be understood that the disclosed embodiments are not necessarily limited in their application to the details of construction and the arrangement of the components set forth in the following description and/or illustrated in the drawings and/or the examples. The disclosed embodiments are capable of variations, or of being practiced or carried out in various ways.

[0092] It will be apparent to those skilled in the art that various modifications and variations can be made to the disclosed devices and systems. Other embodiments will be apparent to those skilled in the art from consideration of the specification and practice of the disclosed devices and systems. It is intended that the specification and examples be considered as exemplary only, with a true scope being indicated by the following claims and their equivalents.

Claims

1. A stabilization system comprising: a payload; and one or more locking systems, each of the one or more locking systems including: a motor configured to adjust an attitude of the payload, the motor comprising a stator and a rotor configured to rotate relative to the stator; a sliding structure capable of engaging the rotor to lock the rotor; and at least one memory alloy wire configured to engage the sliding structure to exert a first force to move the sliding structure in a first sliding direction from a first position to a second position when electrical energy is applied to the at least one memory alloy wire, wherein the applied electrical energy causes a change of a length of the at least one memory alloy wire, and the change of the length of the at least one memory alloy wire exerts the first force to cause a movement of the sliding structure through the engagement of the at least one memory alloy wire with the sliding structure; wherein: when the sliding structure is at the first position, the rotor is not able to rotate relative to the stator by the sliding structure; and when the sliding structure is at the second position, the rotor is able to rotate relative to the stator.
2. The stabilization system of claim 1, further comprising: a restoring member configured to engage the sliding member to exert a second force to move the sliding member in a second sliding direction from the second position to the first position.
3. The stabilization system of claim 2, wherein: the restoring member includes an elastic member; and the elastic member is configured to engage the sliding member to exert the second force to move the sliding member in the second sliding direction from the second position to the first position.
4. The stabilization system of claim 1, wherein the at least one memory alloy wire includes: a first memory alloy wire, configured to engage the sliding member to exert the first force to move the sliding member in the first sliding direction to a locked position when the electrical energy is applied to the first memory alloy wire, wherein the applied electrical energy causes a change of a length of the first memory alloy wire, and the change of the length of the first memory alloy wire exerts the first force to cause a movement of the sliding member through the engagement of the first memory alloy wire with the sliding member; and a second memory alloy wire, configured to

engage the sliding member to exert a second force to move the sliding member in a second sliding direction to an unlocked position when the electrical energy is applied to the second memory alloy wire, wherein the applied electrical energy causes a change of a length of the second memory alloy wire, and the change of the length of the second memory alloy wire exerts the second force to cause a movement of the sliding member through the engagement of the second memory alloy wire with the sliding member.

5. The stabilization system of claim 4, wherein each of the first memory alloy wire and the second memory alloy wire has two fixed ends configured to connect to an electrical energy supply.

6. The stabilization system of claim 5, wherein: the first memory alloy wire is configured to have a shape of a pentagonal arrow including: a contact with a first protrusion of the sliding structure as a tip of the pentagonal arrow; and the two fixed ends of the first memory alloy wire each at a rear end of the pentagonal arrow.

7. The stabilization system of claim 6, wherein the first sliding direction extends from the pentagonal arrow tip to the rear of the pentagonal arrow.

8. The stabilization system of claim 6, wherein: the second memory alloy wire includes one or more turning points; the second memory alloy wire is configured to have a W-shape including: a contact with a second protrusion of the sliding structure as a middle of the W-shape; two turning points of the one or more turning points as two bottom ends of the W-shape; and the two fixed ends of the second memory alloy wire each at a side end of the W-shape.

9. The stabilization system of claim 8, wherein the second sliding direction extends from the middle top to the bottom of the W-shape.

10. The stabilization system of claim 4, wherein: each of the first memory alloy wire and the second memory alloy wire shorten when the electrical energy is applied thereto; the first memory alloy wire is responsive to the applied electrical energy to exert the first force to move the sliding structure to the first position; and the second memory alloy wire is responsive to the applied electrical energy to exert the second force to move the sliding structure to the second position.

11. The stabilization system of claim 10, further comprising: a position limiting structure, wherein: when the sliding structure is moved to the first position, the position limiting structure holds the sliding structure at the first position; and when the sliding structure is moved to the second position, the position limiting structure holds the sliding structure at the second position.

12. The stabilization system of claim 11, wherein: the sliding structure includes a first groove and a second groove; the position limiting structure includes a leaf spring having a protrusion portion; the position limiting structure holds the sliding structure at the first position by the protrusion portion of the leaf spring engaging the first groove when the sliding structure is moved to the first position; and the position limiting structure holds the sliding structure at the second position by the protrusion portion of the leaf spring engaging the second groove when the sliding structure is moved to the second position.

13. The stabilization system of claim 1, wherein: when the motor is powered off, the sliding structure engages the rotor to lock the rotor; and/or when the motor is in a standby mode, the sliding structure engages the rotor to lock the rotor.

14. The stabilization system of claim 1, further comprising: a yaw axis, a roll axis, and a pitch axis; wherein the motor of one of the one or more locking systems is configured to rotate about one of the yaw axis, the roll axis, and the pitch axis.

15. The stabilization system of claim 1, further comprising: a yaw axis, a roll axis, and a pitch axis; wherein the at least one locking system further includes: a first locking system, wherein the motor of the first locking system is configured to rotate about the yaw axis; a second locking system, wherein the motor of the second locking system is configured to rotate about the roll axis; and a third locking system, wherein the motor of the third locking system is configured to rotate about the pitch axis.

16. The stabilization system of claim 1, wherein the each of the one or more locking system further

comprises a path limiting structure limiting the movement of the sliding structure between the first position and the second position along a path.

17. The stabilization system of claim 16, wherein: the path limiting structure includes a straight-line channel, one of a first protrusion and a second protrusion of the sliding structure is received in the straight-line channel and is limited to move along the straight-line channel; the first sliding direction is towards a central axis of the motor; and the second sliding direction is away from the central axis of the motor.

18. The stabilization system of claim 1, wherein: a rotor of the motor includes a motor groove; when the sliding structure is at the first position, a portion of the sliding structure fits into the motor groove to prevent the motor from rotating; and when the sliding structure is at the second position, the sliding structure is withdrawn from the motor groove.

19. The stabilization system of claim 18, wherein the portion of the sliding structure engages the motor groove through a slope surface, and the slope surface is configured to protect the sliding structure from being broken by allowing the sliding structure to withdraw from the motor groove under a force causing displacement between the sliding structure and the motor.

20. A motor locking system for locking and unlocking a motor, comprising: a motor comprising a stator and a rotor configured to rotate relative to the stator; a sliding structure capable of engaging the rotor to lock the rotor; and at least one memory alloy wire configured to engage the sliding structure to exert a first force to move the sliding structure in a first sliding direction from a first position to a second position when electrical energy is applied to the at least one memory alloy wire, wherein the applied electrical energy causes a change of a length of the at least one memory alloy wire, and the change of the length of the at least one memory alloy wire exerts the first force to cause a movement of the sliding structure through the engagement of the at least one memory alloy wire with the sliding structure; wherein: when the sliding structure is at the first position, the rotor is not able to rotate relative to the stator by the sliding structure; and when the sliding structure is at the second position, the rotor is able to rotate relative to the stator.
